

How plants work

Plants have an amazing system for making and transporting food to all their different parts.

Photosynthesis

Leaves have a green pigment called chlorophyll, which absorbs energy from sunlight. This energy is used to change water and carbon dioxide into sugar.

The Sun's energy is trapped in the leaves and helps make food.

Cross-section of a leaf vein

Food is moved from leaves to roots and growing tips along a set of tubes called phloem vessels.

Some water evaporates through tiny holes, called stomata, on the surface of the leaf. This process is called transpiration.

Tiny tubes, called xylem vessels, carry water up the stem from the roots to the leaves.

Cross-section of a stem

Veins carry water around the leaf.

A waste product of photosynthesis is oxygen, which animals need to survive.

Roots suck water up from the ground.